

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM/SOAR | CrowdStrike EDR/XDR | Enterprise Firewall | Financial Services

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience implementing, maintaining and hardening robust security across complex global enterprise infrastructures. I specialise in managing and optimising Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) alert response, and enterprise firewall environments. I bring deep technical expertise with CrowdStrike Falcon, Rapid7, Mimecast, Microsoft Entra ID, Okta and vulnerability management tooling, and I am experienced in reporting to senior IT security leadership and driving measurable security improvements across financial sector environments. I thrive in high-impact, focused security teams where I can take technical ownership of security across a global infrastructure and operate comfortably within financial market hours.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **EDR/XDR Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, Next-Gen SIEM, EDR) - Expert; Rapid7 IDR
- **SIEM and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL); CrowdStrike Next-Gen SIEM; SOAR automation and playbook development
- **Enterprise Firewalls:** Check Point Harmony; Palo Alto (familiar); Cisco Security
- **WAF and DDoS Protection:** Imperva (WAF and DDoS); web application firewall policy management
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast; Menlo (familiar)
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory); Okta; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM); Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM; Tanium
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; AppCheck; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); Nessus; Rapid7 IVM
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61; MITRE ATT&CK framework
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; SOAR playbook authoring
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST CSF; CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials Plus; MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Take technical ownership of implementing, maintaining and hardening robust cyber security across a complex multi-site enterprise environment supporting over 8,000 staff and students
- Manage and optimise the CrowdStrike Falcon platform (Prevent, Insight, Discover, Next-Gen SIEM) for enterprise-wide EDR/XDR alert response, threat hunting and real-time triage across all endpoints
- Operate and enhance SIEM/SOAR platforms, authoring KQL detection rules and automated playbooks to drive down mean time to detect and respond across Priority 1 to Priority 4 security incidents
- Manage email security (Mimecast), enterprise firewall environments (Check Point Harmony), WAF/DDoS controls and web security gateway policies to maintain a resilient security perimeter
- Lead incident response activities aligned to NIST 800-61 and the MITRE ATT&CK framework, coordinating containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review with technical and business stakeholders

- Administer identity and access management via Microsoft Entra ID and Okta, enforcing Conditional Access policies, MFA and SSO across the organisation
- Manage Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, applying least-privilege principles across all administrative accounts and enforcing PAM governance controls
- Conduct vulnerability scanning and risk-prioritised remediation using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), tracking findings to closure within agreed timescales
- Report directly to senior IT security leadership on security posture, incidents, vulnerabilities and project delivery, providing clear technical and operational updates
- Support alignment to ISO 27001, NIST CSF, CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus, contributing to audits and control evidence gathering

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender XDR across 8,000 users, establishing unified endpoint and identity threat visibility across a complex higher education environment
- Performed daily alert triage, threat hunting and security event investigation across SIEM platforms using KQL, continuously tuning detection rules to reduce alert fatigue and improve signal-to-noise ratio
- Operated CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Prevent for continuous endpoint monitoring and real-time EDR/XDR alert response
- Supported enterprise-wide vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports for infrastructure and application teams
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), implementing Conditional Access policies, MFA and SSO across the organisation to strengthen identity governance
- Managed Mimecast email security gateway, configuring policies to protect against phishing, malware and email-borne threats
- Assisted with enterprise firewall and network security administration, supporting perimeter security hardening
- Contributed to BeyondTrust PAM administration, managing privileged account provisioning and periodic access reviews
- Delivered security awareness training to reduce human risk and social engineering susceptibility across the user base

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Implemented and maintained security controls across a cloud-based Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) FinTech platform, covering endpoint protection, network security, firewall configuration and identity access management
- Managed firewall configuration and network security tooling to protect corporate and customer data within a regulated financial technology environment
- Supported vulnerability assessments and security testing activities, identifying and tracking remediation of findings through to closure
- Managed IT infrastructure quality assurance, device management and patch management processes for a distributed cloud-first workforce
- Contributed to security policy development and regulatory compliance activities aligned to financial technology sector requirements

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered enterprise-wide deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Next-Gen SIEM at UAL, establishing real-time endpoint threat visibility across all devices and materially improving alert response times
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, delivering a fully managed EDR/XDR capability at scale that transformed endpoint and identity threat detection

- Built and operationalised SOAR automation playbooks in the SIEM/SOAR environment, reducing manual triage effort for high-volume alert categories and accelerating incident response cycles
- Drove Cyber Essentials Plus certification and sustained alignment to ISO 27001 and NIST CSF, providing independently verified evidence of effective security controls to senior leadership and auditors
- Established a structured vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera BAS, achieving consistent quarter-on-quarter reduction in open critical and high-severity findings

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)